

August 2026

# SUMMER WRAP UP & FALL 2026 BIOLOGY FACULTY NEWSLETTER



OFFICE OF  
UNDERGRADUATE  
RESEARCH AND  
INTERNSHIPS

FLORIDA INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY  
DEPARTMENT OF BIOLOGICAL  
SCIENCES



## Summer Research Internship (SRI) Program

The SRI has officially come to an end! On August 7, our SRI interns presented their summer research projects at the 17<sup>th</sup> Annual SRI Symposium, sharing their work with friends, family, faculty mentors, labs, and judges. After a summer of research, professional development, and hands-on learning, our interns had the opportunity to showcase the knowledge and skills they developed throughout the program. **Congratulations to all of our SRI interns on an incredible summer!**



## Congratulations to this year's award recipients:

🏆 **1<sup>st</sup> place:** Neil Hinduja – Mentor: Dr. Jason Pienaar

🥈 **2<sup>nd</sup> place:** Luis Perez – Mentor: Dr. Yuan Liu

🥉 **3<sup>rd</sup> place:** Lester Machado – Mentor: Dr. Yuan Liu

★ **People's Choice:** Yash Bhatt – Mentor: Dr. Xuexia Wang

## UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH CONFERENCES AND EVENTS

### Sprouting @ FIU

Sprouting is returning this fall! | This **student-led program**, utilizing an **MIT-built curriculum**, introduces students to research through developing a literature review, building skills in scholarly research, synthesis, and scientific communication | **Graduate students and advanced undergraduates** are encouraged to apply as **mentors** and help guide student through the research process | Students interested in exploring research and gaining their first research experience are encouraged to apply as **mentees** | Encourage your students to apply and participate! | **Applications for mentors and mentees will be opening soon!** | Follow @sproutingfiu on Instagram for updates and announcements. For questions or inquiries, please email [sprouting@fiu.edu](mailto:sprouting@fiu.edu)

### Summer Research Poster Showcase

Showcase your research opportunities at the Summer Research Poster Showcase on **September 25, 2026, from 9:00 AM to 4:30 PM in GC 355** | Open to Biology and Marine Biology students who completed a summer research or internship experience in 2026. Students who participated in a summer research or internship experience with Biology's Forensics, SRI, FHRS, QBIC, or other affiliated programs | Encourage your students to submit an abstract and participate in this opportunity! | **Abstracts are due on September 8** | Submit your abstracts here: [Summer Research Poster Showcase Abstract Submission](#)

### Annual Biomedical Research Conference for Minoritized Scientists (ABRCMS)

Students interested in presenting their research at a national conference can consider ABRCMS, taking place **November 18–21, 2026 in Seattle, Washington** | ABRCMS offers undergraduate and graduate students opportunities to present research, network with scientists and peers, explore graduate and professional programs, and learn about STEM careers | **Abstract & Student Travel Award Deadline: September 11** | Encourage your students to apply and participate! | More information: [ABRCMS 2026](#)

### OURI Biology Research Forum

The OURI Biology Research Forum will return on **December 4, 2026**, providing an opportunity for Biology and Marine Biology students to showcase their research and experiences through poster and oral presentations | Open to students who are currently participating in research, completed a summer research programs, or participate in Biology Department programs such as Marine Sciences, Forensics, SRI, QBIC, and others | Encourage your students to submit an abstract and participate! | **More information and registration details coming soon!**

## STUDENT AWARD OPPORTUNITY

### OURI Biology Research Award

Have a **biology-related research idea or scientific project** you're eager to explore? The OURI Biology Research Award provides up to \$500 to support FIU Biology undergraduate students conducting research or developing innovative projects with a faculty mentor | **Applications are due October 2** | Encourage your students to apply! | Submit your applications here: [OURI Biology Research Award](#)

## FACULTY FUNDING AND AWARD OPPORTUNITIES

### CUR Biology Division Research Supply Grants |

The CUR Biology Division is offering a limited number of **grants of up to \$500** for projects involving undergraduate students | Funding is provided as a stipend and is intended for projects where a small grant can make a meaningful impact | **Deadline: October 9, 2026** | More information: [Biology Small Research Grants](#)

### CUR-Goldwater Scholars Faculty Mentor Award

| The CUR and Barry Goldwater Scholarship Foundation recognize STEM faculty mentors who have mentored at least **three Goldwater Scholars** | Awardees receive **national recognition** and **\$5,000 for their institution** to support research and/or undergraduate researchers | **Nomination Deadline: November 13, 2026** | More information: [CUR-Goldwater Award](#)

**For more info please contact:** [areid@fiu.edu](mailto:areid@fiu.edu)  
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